

UNIT 6 — LECTURE 3

Opportunities & Challenges

for the Public Sector

Digitalization in Nepalese Perspective



Cricket vibes

NP

Nepal context



Real examples



Honest truths

“

*Think of Nepal's digitalization like Nepal Cricket.
The potential is HUGE. The talent is there.
But sometimes the pitch is bad, the weather ruins the match,
and half the team didn't show up to practice.
Still — when it works, it's beautiful. 🙌*



OPPORTUNITIES

When digital Nepal works



CHALLENGES

When it hits a pothole



THE WINS — When Digital Nepal Actually Works



WIN 01

**No More Queuing
Like a Goat at Dashain**



WIN 02

**Ghus (Bribe) Gets
Harder to Give**



WIN 03

**COVID Accidentally
Fixed Everything**



WIN 04

**Ward Office Now
Has a Facebook Page**

No More Standing in Line Like a Goat at Dashain

*Passport, land records, tax — services come to
YOU now.*

BEFORE

- Wake up at 4 AM
- Queue for 3 hours
- Told to come back tomorrow
- Repeat. Three. Times. 
- Take a bus from Chitwan to KTM

AFTER

- Fill form online 
- Book a slot in 2 minutes
- Show up at your time
- Done. Go home. Have tea.
- Uncle in Chitwan saves 2 days 

Ghus (Bribe) Gets Harder to Give

THE ANALOGY

Paper files = dark alleys → shady things happen there.

Digital systems = glass office in daylight → everyone sees everything.

Old Way

File sits on babu's desk.
Babu "loses" it unless you
slide something under the table.

New Way

Everything is logged,
timestamped, tracked.
No desk to slide anything under!

E-procurement = contracts published publicly. Minister's brother-in-law can't quietly grab them anymore. 

COVID Accidentally Fixed What 10 Years of Policy Couldn't 🧐

 *Just like you never clean your room — until guests are coming in 10 minutes.
Necessity > Policy. Always.*

2024–2034

Nepal's IT Decade

Goal: Make Nepal an ICT hub

90%

Households with internet

Target by 2029 (16th Plan)

#125

UN E-Gov Index 2022

Up from #132 in 2020

Your Ward Office Now Has a Facebook Page



Public Notices Online

No more missing the notice stuck on a pole outside the ward office. It's on Facebook now.



Complaint = Tag + Post

Broken road? Blocked drain? Tag your municipality. It's not always fixed — but it's visible.



Budget Transparency

Some local governments post annual budgets and spending online. Citizens can actually check.



Direct Communication

Ward chairs respond to messages. Not always fast, but try calling your ward chair in 2005.



Now for the Hard Truths

(Every highway has potholes. Nepal's digital highway has quite a few.)

01

02

03

04

05

06

"Online" Services That Still Need You to Show Up 😞

📄 RAJU'S STORY

Raju reads that he can get his citizenship copy online.
He fills the form. Submits it. Gets a confirmation email. 📧

Goes to collect it... Office says: "Sir, please bring the original form physically." 🧑

60

Services promised
in Nagarik App

45

Services actually
integrated

The Internet in Rural Nepal is Playing Games 🏔️

41%

of rural Nepal has
reliable internet

🏠 SITA IN HUMLA

Sita wants to use the government app to register her land.

- 🌐 App needs internet
- ⚡ Internet needs electricity
- 🕒 Electricity comes 4 hrs/day
- 🔋 Phone battery died 2 hours ago.

The service exists. Sita cannot use it.

💡 *The highway is built. But half the country doesn't have a vehicle to drive on it.*

CHALLENGE 03

Government Depts Don't Talk to Each Other

You submit your citizenship number to:

- IRD (tax) • Passport Office
- Municipality • Bank

Does any system share data? NO.
Each department is its own little island.

 *Like re-introducing yourself in every class, every day. With a new photo. Every time.*

CHALLENGE 04

The Babu Who Refuses to Touch the Computer

Many officials believe: if they ignore the computer long enough, it'll go away.

Nepal: 13+ PMs in 16 years.
Every new govt = new priorities = half-finished digital projects. 💀

 *Installing a new OS on a machine that refuses to reboot.*

Security Holes & Who Gets Left Out

Cybersecurity — No Safety Net

No proper Personal Data Protection Act yet.
Your fingerprints, photo, national ID data — all stored.
Is it safe? Nobody is legally required to ensure it.

TIA airport has had system crashes → flight delays.

 *You built a house. It has a door. But no lock. And you're surprised someone walked in. 🏠*

Who Gets Left Out?

80% of online government service users = male.
60% of users = under 30 years old.

Your 65-year-old grandmother who needs
a pension? Nobody built the app for her.

 *Digital services for everyone — designed only for a 24-year-old tech bro in Kathmandu. 🧑*



THE HONEST SCORECARD — Opportunities vs Challenges



WINS

No more 4am queues 🕒

Bribe culture harder digitally 🏛️

COVID forced rapid adoption 🧐

IT Decade 2024–2034 declared 🚀

Ward offices go online 📺

UN E-Gov rank: 132→125 📈



CHALLENGES

Services still need physical visits 😞

Departments don't share data 🌴

41% rural = no reliable internet 📶

13+ PMs = half-finished projects 💀

80% users = male, under 30 🧑

No data protection law yet 🗝️